

Philipp Hilbert. *Institutional-grade product thinking for tokenized real-world assets.*

Positioning, ten years building regulated, cross-functional software products — now applying that depth to the infrastructure layer that makes RWAs usable at scale.

BERLIN, GERMANY · [HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](mailto:hilbert@true-north.berlin) · [TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](https://true-north.berlin)

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§ WHY PLUME

Plume is one of the few teams building the full stack — asset onboarding, compliance infrastructure, vault mechanics, and partner integrations — as a coherent product rather than a patchwork of point solutions. The job description names KYC/AML, Reg D/S, custodian integrations, and institutional-grade TVL metrics in the same breath as sprint planning and PRDs, which is exactly the operating mode I am most productive in. What drew me in specifically is the Nest vault ecosystem: designing a product that abstracts yield-bearing RWA exposure for end users while remaining compliant with securities frameworks is a genuinely hard product problem, not a token-wrapper exercise. *That is the kind of constraint-rich, cross-functional environment where the difference between a good PM and an average one compounds fast.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not held a PM title at a crypto-native company or issued a tokenized security directly. My Web3 background is eight years of hands-on user experience across DEXes, bridges, AMMs, perpetual markets, and on-chain custody — deep user-side fluency rather than issuer-side product ownership. The transferable mechanic is strong: I have shipped regulated software products at defence, public-sector, and insurance scale, where legal and compliance teams were co-designers on the roadmap, not a late gate.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec drafting and edge-case generation
 - **GitHub Copilot**, implementation support and code review
 - **Cursor/VSCoDe**, daily development environment
 - **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
 - **Framer**, design-heavy mockups and stakeholder walkthroughs
 - **Gamma.app**, structured PRD and deck authoring
 - **n8n**, multi-agent workflow orchestration
 - **GPT**, exploratory research, competitive analysis, and refinement prep
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kotlin (Spring Boot), Python, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redpanda, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Argo Workflows, OpenShift, Helm, Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, Django, JavaScript, AngularJS, Ionic, MicroStrategy, Jenkins, Bitbucket, REST APIs, CGM API integration, low-code insurance platforms, GitOps pipelines, CI/CD with test integration at build time.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CRYPTO BACKTEST ENGINE [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/hilbertp) →

A personal infrastructure project for algorithmic strategy development across centralised and decentralised venues.

- Ingests historical order book and trade data from CEX and DEX sources for backtesting perpetual and spot strategies.
- Architecture uses a file-queue-based agent loop; trade logic and risk rules are declarative and version-controlled.
- Developed in parallel with live trading across Hyperliquid, Bitget, Jupiter, 1inch, and Across Protocol.
- Demonstrates the infrastructure-first thinking Plume needs in a PM who can scope smart contract and oracle dependencies with engineers rather than around them.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT PLUME

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow every live integration touchpoint – issuer onboarding, KYC/AML flows, Nest vault configurations – and produce a written map of where the spec ends and tribal knowledge begins, flagging the highest-friction handoffs between engineering, legal, and BD.

WEEK 2

Prioritise with data.

Pull TVL growth, activation, and transaction success rate dashboards; sit with the data and engineering team to validate which gaps from week one are causing measurable drop-off versus which are noise, then draft a single-page prioritisation memo for leadership.

WEEK 3+

Ship, close loops.

Own the first sprint grooming cycle for my product area, turning the prioritisation memo into refined stories with acceptance criteria, compliance sign-off checkpoints, and partner integration requirements scoped tightly enough for engineering to start without a second meeting.

I COVER LETTER

Plume is building something I have been watching closely: a protocol layer that makes tokenized real-world assets accessible without hiding the regulatory complexity under a thin veneer. The Nest vault ecosystem, the compliance/KYC infrastructure, and the partner integration surface are product areas where the hard work is not the smart contract – it is the cross-functional coordination between legal, engineering, custodians, and issuers. That is a problem I have spent a decade learning to solve.

At Rohde & Schwarz, I was the PM for a central AI data management platform inside the European defence programme FCAS – a project where multinational legal frameworks, data provenance requirements, and strict auditability constraints were first-class product requirements, not afterthoughts. I introduced GitOps-based rollout pipelines, reduced deployment times from several days to under forty minutes, and delivered features end-to-end including user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation, testing, and rollout. I mention this

not because defence and DeFi are equivalent, but because working inside a hard regulatory envelope while maintaining engineering velocity is a specific operational skill – and Plume's job description is asking for exactly that.

At Emil Group, I joined an InsurTech SaaS platform that was losing client trust and developer retention simultaneously. I split a bloated seventeen-person team into functional Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production. The domain – primary insurers, reinsurers, MGAs, underwriters – is as paper-heavy and compliance-constrained as securities issuance. The PM job in that environment is to hold the legal and engineering conversations in the same room and translate between them without losing either side. That is the same skill the Plume role names when it says "partner with Legal/Compliance early and often."

My Web3 context is genuine rather than credential-polished. Eight years of hands-on experience across DEXes, AMMs, perpetual markets, bridges, and on-chain custody has given me a specific kind of user research that is hard to fake: I know where real users get stuck, where trust breaks, and which product decisions create invisible risks that surface only under stress. I actively trade across Hyperliquid, Bitget, Jupiter, and 1inch, analyze execution quality with Coinglass and Hyblock Capital, and have built my own backtesting infrastructure for crypto strategies. That background means I can walk into a conversation about oracle dependency, liquidity risk in vault design, or cross-chain bridge assumptions and engage substantively rather than nod along.

I am based in Berlin, work remote, and am available within four weeks of an offer. I would welcome a conversation about which product area – asset onboarding, the Nest ecosystem, compliance infrastructure, or partner integrations – is the most constrained right now, and where a PM who can run tight cross-functional loops would move the needle fastest.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Founding Product Manager with nearly ten years of experience building regulated, cross-functional software products from ambiguous requirements to production rollout. Background spans AI data platforms, public analytics infrastructure, InsurTech SaaS, healthcare, and quantum-secure encryption – consistently in environments where legal, compliance, and engineering had to move together. Brings hands-on Web3 fluency across DEX mechanics, perpetual markets, bridging, and on-chain custody, combined with the institutional stakeholder

discipline that tokenized RWA products demand. Operates AI-native by default: from spec to prototype to GitOps deployment.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Regulated product roadmap ownership across engineering, legal, and BD stakeholders
 - Cross-functional execution in compliance-constrained environments
 - Technical fluency sufficient to scope smart contract and infrastructure tradeoffs
 - Structured PRD, spec, and success-metric authorship
 - Backlog discipline, sprint grooming, and delivery velocity recovery
 - KPI definition and data-informed prioritisation
 - AI-native product execution and rapid prototyping
 - End-to-end feature delivery including GitOps rollout
 - Founder-level pragmatism: low ego, high agency, short feedback loops
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§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps rollout – with full data provenance and auditability for multinational stakeholders
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD
- Unblocked infrastructure-level issues in OpenShift independently; sole developer for a feature the project lead had been requesting from engineers for over a year – delivered in one week
- Led cross-functional team of architect, data scientists, backend/frontend engineers, and QA inside the European defence programme FCAS
- Introduced SafeAI and ExplainableAI evaluation concepts for ML training datasets

Tech: Kotlin (Spring Boot), Python, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redpanda, Kubernetes, Argo Workflows, ArgoCD, OpenShift

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Delivered labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison tooling, and modernised admin interfaces on the Arbeitsmarktmonitor platform
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and reproducible indicator generation; migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer (IT-SV) with focus on compliance, governance, and data lineage
- Standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time

Tech: Python, Django, JavaScript, PostgreSQL, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, MicroStrategy, Kubernetes, Jenkins, Bitbucket

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production; also shipped product configuration, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance, document management, and workflow automation modules
- Re-established sprint discipline on a failing project: split a bloated 17-person team into focused Scrum units, introduced ownership and deputy concepts, reintroduced velocity tracking
- Regained client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured communication and weekly product workshops
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure

Tech: Low-code platform, Java, HTML/CSS, Kubernetes, REST APIs

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core patient flows – digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, document storage – on iOS and Android under tight deadlines
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system workflows; managed legacy API constraints transparently with stakeholders

Tech: AngularJS, Ionic, Python, Kubernetes, CGM API integration

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner – Quantum-Secure Encryption

- Owned backup, restore/checkpoint, and data-encryption product architecture for a one-time-pad encryption product with a true random number generator hardware layer
- USP: setup under two minutes, no technical knowledge required; also served as Deputy IT Security Officer

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder & CFO

- Built a group-based P2P payments product on a P2P backbone: PSP integration, full UX/UI design, mobile app prototype
- Later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES 2016, 2021

Co-Founder, CDO, CFO, Project Lead

- Established digital tooling, ERP, financial and investment planning for an agritech startup in vertical indoor farming; led investor relations and nanotechnology development over five years

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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